

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a magazine article about team sports:

Team sports

Sports can be expensive for some families. Not only that, the training can be very tough, requiring long hours of practice. Additionally, in individual sports (like tennis, squash, etc.), it can be quite lonely sometimes without having teammates to train with. It might also be difficult to handle failure in competitions too. Is it worth pursuing sports then? Most definitely yes, especially playing in team sports (like football, volleyball, etc.).

There are certainly many well-known benefits of physical activity and sports in general. However, playing team sports provides extra benefits. Being part of a team demands commitment, punctuality, encouraging your teammates, and team-work. Team sports also mean that young people can make friends outside of school and learn how to work towards achieving a common goal.

According to a research study in *ScienceDaily* last year, a Youth Risk Behaviour survey was conducted on 1,820 high school students in America. Researchers found that playing team sports could reduce bullying and violence in everyday life. The findings indicated that boys who played team sports were less bullied than boys in individual sports. Boys who did not participate in any sport experienced the most bullying. Girls who played either individual or team sports were less likely to get into fights, compared to girls who did not play any sports at all.

As members of your school's Sports Club, your group is to give a presentation to your schoolmates about team sports. Discuss with your group what to include in the presentation. You may want to talk about:

- the benefits of playing team sports compared to individual sports
- the disadvantages of playing team sports compared to individual sports
- how team sports can be promoted in Hong Kong
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you play team sports?
2. Would you prefer to play in team sports or individual sports?
3. Do you prefer watching team sports or individual sports?
4. Would your parents allow you to become a professional sportsperson?
5. Why is it sometimes difficult to encourage people to play sports?
6. Should more money be invested in developing facilities for team sports in Hong Kong?
7. Do you agree that playing team sports reduces violence?
8. Is it more difficult to handle failure in individual or team sports?